

This article was downloaded by: [University of Guelph]

On: 15 September 2012, At: 01:06

Publisher: Routledge

Informa Ltd Registered in England and Wales Registered Number: 1072954 Registered office: Mortimer House, 37-41 Mortimer Street, London W1T 3JH, UK



Studies in Higher Education

Publication details, including instructions for authors and subscription information:

<http://www.tandfonline.com/loi/cshe20>

The best of both worlds? Towards an English for Academic Purposes/ Academic Literacies writing pedagogy

Ursula Wingate^a & Christopher Tribble^a

^a Department of Education and Professional Studies, King's College London, Waterloo Road, London, SE1 9NH, UK

Version of record first published: 12 May 2011.

To cite this article: Ursula Wingate & Christopher Tribble (2012): The best of both worlds? Towards an English for Academic Purposes/Academic Literacies writing pedagogy, *Studies in Higher Education*, 37:4, 481-495

To link to this article: <http://dx.doi.org/10.1080/03075079.2010.525630>

PLEASE SCROLL DOWN FOR ARTICLE

Full terms and conditions of use: <http://www.tandfonline.com/page/terms-and-conditions>

This article may be used for research, teaching, and private study purposes. Any substantial or systematic reproduction, redistribution, reselling, loan, sub-licensing, systematic supply, or distribution in any form to anyone is expressly forbidden.

The publisher does not give any warranty express or implied or make any representation that the contents will be complete or accurate or up to date. The accuracy of any instructions, formulae, and drug doses should be independently verified with primary sources. The publisher shall not be liable for any loss, actions, claims, proceedings, demand, or costs or damages whatsoever or howsoever caused arising directly or indirectly in connection with or arising out of the use of this material.

The best of both worlds? Towards an English for Academic Purposes/Academic Literacies writing pedagogy

Ursula Wingate* and Christopher Tribble

Department of Education and Professional Studies, King's College London, Waterloo Road, London, SE1 9NH, UK

This article is a review of two dominant approaches to academic writing instruction in higher education, English for Academic Purposes (EAP), which is used internationally, and Academic Literacies, which has become an influential model in the UK. The review was driven by a concern that Academic Literacies has been mainly focused on the situations of 'non-traditional' students, and has not sufficiently acknowledged the theoretical and pedagogical potential of EAP for developing a mainstream instructional model. Another concern was that EAP is too focused on the needs of non-native speakers of English and has, therefore, failed to make an impact on mainstream writing instruction. The aim of this article is to critically examine both approaches and to identify shared principles that can be used for developing relevant writing support programmes for students from all backgrounds at UK universities and elsewhere.

Keywords: academic acculturation; academic literacies; academic writing; language and academic skills; English language teaching

Introduction

There has been an increasing awareness in the last two decades that students from all backgrounds entering the British higher education system need support with academic writing. While access to the university has been opened to a wider range of UK students, and the recruitment of international students has been steadily increasing, the provision of support for these groups has been unequally distributed. The help that is available falls mainly into two separate and apparently mutually exclusive strands. The first of these is writing instruction for non-native-speakers of English, offered at most universities exclusively to 'foreign' students, usually in English Language Centres. The second strand consists of remedial writing workshops or courses, where writing is taught generically as part of 'study skills' to students of all disciplines, typically in Learning Support or Study Skills units.

Both types of provision have been criticised for neglecting some fundamental issues: first, that learning to write in an academic discipline is not a purely linguistic matter that can be fixed outside the discipline, but involves an understanding of how knowledge in the discipline is presented, debated and constructed. The second issue is that reading, reasoning and writing in a specific discipline is difficult for native and non-native speakers, or, in other terms, home and international students alike. Therefore, a support provision that is reserved for non-native speakers of English, or as a

*Corresponding author. Email: ursula.wingate@kcl.ac.uk

remedy for students who are at risk of failing, is outdated for today's student generation. There is clearly a need to develop a theoretical and practical 'mainstream' approach to teaching writing that takes into account the complexities of academic writing and the diverse backgrounds of students at UK universities.

In this article we want to contribute to the development of this type of mainstream approach by making proposals for the constructive sharing of best practice from two influential models of academic writing instruction. For this purpose, we will review a version of English for Academic Purposes (EAP) which is based on genre and social constructivist theory, and is used in various formats around the world (henceforward Genre/EAP), and Academic Literacies, which is based on case-study and ethnographic research into instructional practices at UK universities. We focus on these two models because both, being based on extensive research (and practice in the case of Genre/EAP), have much to offer for mainstream writing instruction, but have so far failed to make an impact on it. Whilst Genre/EAP has been largely restricted to non-native speakers of English, Academic Literacies has never formulated pedagogical guidelines. Academic Literacies theorists have criticised the focus on discipline-specific texts in what they have called EAP (e.g. Lillis and Scott 2007); however, they have themselves offered few practical alternatives to the models they have criticised. Furthermore, the lack of reference in the Academic Literacies literature to the large body of research and pedagogic literature associated with EAP suggests that Academic Literacies proponents might not be fully aware of the contributions EAP has made to the theory and practice of academic writing (Tribble 2009, 403).

We believe that, in order to develop a writing pedagogy suitable for students across the UK's higher education sector, it is necessary to examine critically the concepts and claims put forward by both models, and to consider how they might complement each other. We hope that this critical examination will help to clear up a few myths and to identify practical ways forward.

Academic Literacies: history, characteristics and pedagogical impact

The Academic Literacies model originates from practice-oriented research in the UK's higher education sector in the 1990s, most notably by Lea and Street (1998). Its theoretical underpinnings come from the 'New Literacy Studies' (Barton 1994; Street 1984), in which writing and reading are understood as social and context-dependent practices that are influenced by factors such as power relations, the epistemologies of specific disciplines and students' identities. According to Russell et al. (2009), another theoretical framework for Academic Literacies was provided by Bazerman's (1988) early work in the USA, which follows the social constructionist perspective. Since the late 1990s, Academic Literacies has been an influential voice in the UK's discussion on academic writing, as evidenced in a large number of publications and conference contributions.

Whilst academic writing instruction for students from all backgrounds, not just for non-native speakers of English, had been the focus of research in the USA and Australia for decades, until the 1990s it had received only occasional attention (e.g. Hounsell 1987) in the UK. The reason for the late interest is that widening participation has been a relatively new phenomenon in the UK. In the previous highly selective admissions system, students were expected to be able to write adequately at university; support, if at all, was offered to the few 'at risk' students – those who were for some reason not adequately prepared by their secondary school education – in a remedial fashion

and outside the discipline. As mentioned earlier, these support practices have remained largely unchanged, despite the student population now being much more diverse and less specifically prepared for the literacy requirements at university. Research into the transition from school to university has revealed the struggle of ‘beginning students at all levels’ to understand these requirements (Haggis 2006, 522; Krause 2001).

Lea and Street (1998) were the first to expose the inadequacy of academic writing instruction at UK universities, and to challenge widespread perceptions – held by many lecturers in higher education and echoed in media reports – of falling standards due to ‘deficient’ students. One of Lea and Street’s insights, based on a research project in UK universities in the 1990s, was that students, particularly those engaged in interdisciplinary studies, are exposed to a variety of practices. The understanding that there is no singular literacy practice is expressed in the plural form ‘Academic Literacies’. Lea and Street also highlighted the complexity of institutional and disciplinary requirements, which may be in conflict with students’ identities and previous experiences. The problems that students experience with writing tend to be at the epistemological rather than the linguistic level, and are often caused by gaps between academic staff expectations and student interpretations of what is involved in academic writing. As a result, according to Lea and Street, writing cannot be taught as technical skills outside the discipline, in what they have called the ‘study skills’ approach. Neither, in their view, is it sufficient to induct students into the discourses and genres of specific academic disciplines, an approach which Lea and Street call ‘academic socialisation’.

The novelty of the model, as Academic Literacies researchers point out, is that it ‘constitutes a shift, as it sees writing as a social phenomenon’ (Lillis 2001, 27), and as ‘social practice’ which is dependent on its particular context (Lea and Street 1998, 159). To highlight the social and ideological nature of writing, Academic Literacies has drawn on New Literacy Studies (Street 1984), critical discourse analysis (Fairclough 1992) and critical language awareness (Ivanič 1998). Lillis and Scott assert that ‘many approaches can be broadly described as socially oriented, but what marks out the academic literacies approach is the extent to which *practice* is privileged above *text*’ (2007, 10, italics in original). Rather than analysing texts to identify what the writing requirements of a discipline are, it is ‘the definition and articulation of what constitutes the “problem” [with student writing] that is at the heart of much academic literacies research’ (2007, 9). The concept of writing as social practice may represent a new perspective for practitioners in the UK; it is, however, not new in the US context, having been established by Bazerman (1988) and Berkenkotter and Huckin (1995), and it also underpins much of the work of Genre/EAP.

A critical stance towards existing writing instruction is the main characteristic of Academic Literacies. For this reason, the model has been described as a ‘critical research frame’ (Lillis 2003, 195) and an ‘oppositional frame to conventional approaches to student writing’ (Lillis 2006, 32). At the same time, Academic Literacies researchers have acknowledged the model’s lack of pedagogical application (Lillis 2001, 2006; Lillis and Scott 2007), and called for the development of Academic Literacies as a ‘design frame with a focus on pedagogy’ (Lea and Street 2006, 369). Furthermore, the claims made by Academic Literacies are so far based on small-scale case studies and ethnographic research (Lillis and Scott 2007), and are often concerned with ‘non-traditional’ students. As Lillis and Scott (2007, 22) acknowledge, larger scale or specifically designed research would be needed to provide a systematic and representative account of student experiences with academic writing

across the UK's higher education sector. So far, little attention has been paid in Academic Literacies research to the experience of 'traditional' home students, or of international students for whom English is a second or additional language. As previously mentioned, all students, whether they are native or non-native speakers of English, or 'non-traditional' or 'traditional' students, are novices when dealing with academic discourse in the disciplines (Thesen and van Pletzen 2006). Research-based guidelines and principles are needed to replace the existing instructional provision with a writing pedagogy that caters for all novices. These are not currently offered by Academic Literacies.

By contrast, EAP and other genre-based approaches provide writing pedagogies that are based on a long history of practitioner experience and research into the specific practices of disciplines. Whilst criticising these pedagogies as too text-oriented, Academic Literacies proponents have begun to realise the importance of texts for developing the model into a pedagogic design frame. Baynham (2000, 19), for instance, acknowledges that it is 'important not to lose touch with the sharply focused specificity which text-based studies provide', and that 'we need precise linguistic accounts'. Equally, Lillis and Scott (2007, 21) recognise a 'lack of attention to text', and see it as a key challenge to 'bring the text back into the frame' (22).

Some applications of the Academic Literacies model to pedagogical practice have been proposed for the UK context, although the extent to which these can be applied broadly to practical classroom teaching is not clear. Lillis (2001, 2006), for instance, argues for various types of dialogue to enable students' participation in academic writing practices. These dialogues take place between the individual student and their tutor, aiming at familiarising students with the relevant practices, raising language awareness or what Lillis calls 'making language visible' (2006, 34), ensuring that the students can express their own intentions, and giving students the opportunity to express their feelings about existing conventions. Whilst this approach would certainly be 'desirable' (2006, 34) and most helpful for the individual – resembling the one-to-one tutoring at Oxford and Cambridge universities – administrators may argue that the necessary resources are not available in mainstream higher education in the UK.

Lea (2004) illustrates how Academic Literacies principles can be integrated into curriculum design. For instance, the various texts presented in an online course at the Open University contain an element of critique, alerting students to potential discrepancies between prior writing practices and those required at university, and helping them to recognise that knowledge is constructed, rather than merely represented through writing. However, Lea (2004, 752) admits that institutional assessment practices might limit the integration of these principles into course design. Lastly, Lea and Street (2006) describe the application of Academic Literacies research to instructional practice in two case studies. The first presents workshops supporting law lecturers in writing course materials. In order to highlight the importance of student identity and the difficulty students might have in expressing their voice, the lecturers were encouraged to look at writing from the student perspective. The second case study presents an outreach programme in which pre-university students from linguistic minorities were made aware of the different genres and the multimodality of academic discourses. This programme is also discussed in Scalone and Street (2006).

These applications of Academic Literacies theory to pedagogy provide valuable ideas for specific – and perhaps, in terms of resources, rather privileged – contexts, but fall short of giving directions for mainstream higher education. It is, therefore, not

surprising that the few significant mainstream writing development initiatives at UK universities are not associated with Academic Literacies but follow the 'Writing in the Disciplines' model (Monroe 2002, 2003). One example is the 'Thinking Writing' project at Queen Mary, University of London, which has been running successfully since 2001 (Mitchell and Evison 2006). Writing in the Disciplines also underpins the work of the 'Write Now' Center of Excellence in Teaching and Learning (London Metropolitan University), and a writing development project discussed by Somerville and Crème (2005). Based on many years of research and practical experience, the model is widely used in US universities (Russell et al. 2009). Unlike Academic Literacies, Writing in the Disciplines provides a clear pedagogical manifesto; that is that the teaching of writing should be 'an integral, ongoing part of disciplinary learning for all students' (Mitchell and Evison 2006, 71–72). This means that writing instruction is firmly embedded in the discipline's curriculum, and to a certain extent delivered by subject lecturers as part of the regular subject teaching (Wingate 2010).

English for Academic Purposes – history, characteristics and pedagogical impact

Tribble (2009) has commented that English for Academic Purposes, as currently practised in many higher education institutions, from the UK and the USA, to Hong Kong and Australasia, has a close relationship with:

the research and pedagogic practices associated with English for Specific Purposes and is rooted in Halliday, McIntosh and Stevens' (1964) ground-breaking work in register analysis and Halliday and Hasan's (1985) later work on genre. An EAP programme in this tradition typically requires thorough accounts of both the communicative context and the linguistic behaviour arising from this context as the starting points for any pedagogic solutions that are developed to meet learners' needs. (401)

EAP can be seen as a child of the English for Specific Purposes movement dating back to the 1960s. In recent years it has built on the seminal work of John Swales (cf. Swales 1981, 1988, 1990, 2004, and Swales and Feak 1994, 2002), and has been developed by a group of practitioners and researchers associated with the *English for Specific Purposes Journal* and the *Journal of English for Academic Purposes*. This version of EAP is best understood within the tradition of London School Linguistics, and has to be differentiated from other varieties of EAP: e.g. approaches associated with the rhetorical tradition in US College Composition (Jordan 1992), with Discourse Studies (Prior 1998), or Process Writing (Raimes 1991).

The intellectual foundations of what we call Genre/EAP in this article can be traced through the British tradition in applied linguistics (Stubbs 1996). Halliday's contribution has been central to this project, especially in the areas of register and genre analysis (Halliday and Hasan 1985; Halliday, McIntosh, and Stevens 1964; Martin and Rose 2007), along with Sinclair's work in discourse analysis (e.g. Sinclair and Coulthard 1975) and corpus linguistics (e.g. Sinclair 1991). Recent publications such as Hyland (2004) and Biber (2006) can be seen as logical continuations of the London School tradition.

Stubbs offers a set of core principles for this kind of linguistics, and these are directly relevant to this discussion. In summary, Stubbs holds that linguistics is best understood as an applied social science whose data (language) 'should be studied in attested, authentic instances of use', based on the understanding that 'language in use involves both routine and creation, and that language transmits culture' (1996, 23).

At each step in its development, Genre/EAP has drawn on these principles, and has attempted to build a *practical* response to student needs (mainly in higher education settings). Although Genre/EAP was mainly applied to English as a Foreign Language teaching in the UK, the pedagogic implications of a socially grounded linguistics have not been restricted to English as a Foreign Language, as can be seen in Halliday's ground-breaking *Breakthrough to Literacy* project in the 1960s (Halliday 2003), innovations in Australian mainstream education (Christie 1993; Martin 1989), and corpora of academic English.

Throughout the development of Genre/EAP, the notion of *genre* has remained problematic. Part of the difficulty has been that the word *genre* was colonised by Halliday in the development of Systemic Functional Linguistics but was never consistently defined. The conceptualisation of genre that is widely drawn on in EAP stems from Halliday's early assertion that 'social context is predictive of text' (Halliday 1978, 189), an early account of genre being given by Halliday and Hasan, where they comment that 'genre is language doing the job appropriate to that class of social happenings' (1985, 108). However, this view of genre does not fully accord with later accounts, where genre is presented as a form of social action which enables and constrains choice at the levels of register, lexis, grammar and phonology (Martin 1992), or as being closely associated with text type (Paltridge 1996). This lack of clarity regarding the term itself has continued to be a source of some confusion for practitioners.

An important attempt to bring clarity to the discussion can be found in Swales's (1990) seminal definition of genre. This built on Halliday and Hasan, and attempted to clarify the relationship between communicative context, discourse community, genre and text type in order to establish a pedagogically useful account of language use in specific social settings. Key features in this account are that:

A genre comprises a class of communicative events, the members of which share some set of communicative purposes. These purposes are recognised by the expert members of the parent discourse community and thereby constitute the rationale for the genre. This rationale shapes the schematic structure of the genre and influences and constrains choice of content and style. Communicative purpose is both a privileged criterion and one that operates to keep the scope of a genre as here conceived narrowly focused on comparable rhetorical action. (Swales 1990, 58)

Although Bhatia (1993) and Swales have identified limitations to this definition, with Askehave and Swales (2001) proposing a clarification of the role of communicative purpose, it has remained central to the Genre/EAP project, and has had a profound influence on the development of higher education academic writing programmes for speakers of languages other than English in the UK, the USA, Australia and elsewhere.

Ongoing work in Genre/EAP has started to offer systematic accounts of the range of genres which are associated with higher education social practices, and to establish pedagogic responses to learners' needs in these contexts (Charles 2007). Critically, these accounts have been based on detailed and comparative linguistic analyses of the texts that are associated with specific genres, and on systematic investigations of the social practices of participants in the discourse communities which own these genres. This approach is central to major contributions to EAP literature such as Hyland (2004), whose title *Disciplinary discourses: social interactions in academic writing* clearly indicates the direction that is being taken.

Recent developments in the construction of corpora of academic speaking and writing, such as the Michigan Corpus of Academic Spoken English (MICASE) and the British Academic Written English corpus (BAWE), the burgeoning availability of electronic versions of academic texts (both published expert writing and apprentice texts from students), and the growing awareness amongst EAP teachers of how to develop and exploit specialist corpora, are leading to a dramatic change in the specificity of the writing instruction that can be offered to EAP learners across a wide range of disciplines. Although commercial pressures may at times be seen as militating against the development of such tightly specified programmes (Hyland 2002; Tribble 2009), a review of article titles from a recent issue of the key journal in the field for EAP practitioners, the *Journal of English for Academic Purposes* (Volume 9, March 2010), indicates the kinds of interests and concerns of teachers and researchers working within EAP. These include a focus on the complexity and explicitness of academic writing, accounts of academic discourse in other languages, and a concern for both the products and processes involved in integrating source materials and balancing authority in undergraduate writing.

One of the crucial features of Genre/EAP has been that research has always been linked to pedagogy. Although it is fair to say that most pedagogic applications have been locally produced and applied (e.g. Hafner and Candlin 2007), major published course books have also arisen from this approach. Notable amongst these are Swales and Feak (1994, 2002), which are widely used with graduate students (both native and non-native speakers of English), along with other innovative work such as Thurston and Candlin's (1997) corpus-based course book, and Cox and Hill's (2007) lower level materials for academic writing.

Along with Swales (2009), we hold that Academic Literacies theorists have tended to offer an insufficiently nuanced account of what they characterise as EAP, and have, thereby, ignored or marginalised important contributions that have been made in this field. Given the significant body of research which informs Genre/EAP and the major pedagogic applications which have flowed from this research, it is somewhat surprising that Academic Literacies researchers dismiss EAP because it only has 'overseas and international students using English as a foreign language at the centre of both pedagogic and research interest' (Lillis and Scott 2007, 10). Is it not the case, rather, that the substantial body of research and practice which has been developed in Genre/EAP is something which should be drawn on rather than ignored?

Comments and criticisms of Genre/EAP approaches in the Academic Literacies literature

In the Academic Literacies model, all categories of EAP are subsumed under the label 'academic socialisation', with no real distinction being made between genre-informed approaches and others flavours of EAP. Alongside this potential problem, there seem to be different understandings of 'academic socialisation'. One view is that it merely involves students 'picking up' writing conventions implicitly 'as part of their studies without any specific teaching or practice' (Lillis 2006, 32). This understanding is associated with the 'Communities of Practice' model (Lave and Wenger 1991), in which the student moves from 'legitimate peripheral participation' to full membership of the academic discourse community. If, indeed, the community's discourse conventions and practices remain unarticulated, reaching full participation would certainly be a lengthy process. It has been suggested that this process is exactly what many

students in UK universities experience, unless they are identified as 'weak' and sent to remedial classes (e.g. Northedge 2003). In these circumstances, 'academic socialisation' cannot be called an instructional approach, as the development of writing is left to the students' ability to learn from the community by observation.

The second understanding of 'academic socialisation' is of it as a conscious instructional approach to teaching writing in reaction to 'the crudity and insensitivity of this [the study skills] approach' (Lea and Street 1998, 159). Academic socialisation in this sense would mean that teachers in the disciplines take the active role of inducting students 'into the new culture of the academy' (Lea and Street 1998, 159). So far, there is scarce evidence of this approach being used in UK universities; rather there is evidence that academics are unwilling to get involved with developing students' writing (Haggis, 2006; Mitchell and Evison 2006), or lack the confidence to offer this kind of support (Bailey, 2010).

Lea and Street (1998) regard 'academic socialisation' as encapsulated by the Academic Literacies model, whereby the latter has a broader perspective, taking into account identity, power relations and institutional practices. Duff (2010, 171), however, expresses doubts about this 'higher-order, value-added perspective', and argues that 'language and literacy socialisation will almost inevitably involve the negotiation of power and identity'. In whatever way Academic Literacies proponents may understand academic socialisation, they have tended to project a narrative of a narrow, prescriptive initiation into literacy conventions onto approaches which explicitly teach the characteristics of writing in particular genres and disciplines.

The main criticism levelled against these approaches is their 'textual bias' (Lillis and Scott 2007, 11). In the view of Lea and Street, the underlying assumption for the focus on texts is that 'the academy is a relatively homogenous culture' (1998, 159). Academic socialisation models, according to Lea, assume that the norms and practices of the homogeneous culture 'can be learnt in order to get access to the whole institution' (2004, 741). Furthermore, these models are accused of assuming 'the homogeneity of student population, stability of disciplines, uni-directionality of teacher-student relation' (Kress 2007, cited in Lillis and Scott 2007, 13). As a result, academic socialisation approaches 'often fail to recognise the multiplicity of communities of practice within the academy' (Lea 2004, 741).

Furthermore, there is a claim that the focus on texts leads to academic socialisation approaches being 'normative' (Lillis and Scott 2007, 9). According to Lillis and Scott, the aim of academic socialisation approaches is to identify academic conventions and induct students into using them (2007, 13). By contrast, the Academic Literacies model is presented as 'transformative', locating academic conventions in the wider context of traditions of knowledge construction, and considering the impact of these conventions on the writers' ability to express their voice, and explore 'alternative ways of meaning making' (2007, 13).

Response to the criticisms of Genre/EAP approaches in the Academic Literacies literature

Some of the criticisms of what Lea and Street call the 'academic socialisation' model seem to refer to EAP practices which might still have been in place at the time of the authors' seminal publication (1998). These criticisms persist, however, and they do not take in account Genre/EAP's founding principles, recent literature and innovation in current instructional practice. To our knowledge, no systematic analysis of Genre/

EAP has appeared in Academic Literacies publications, and there are claims (for instance that of EAP's assumption of the academy being a homogeneous culture) that need further or clearer explanation if they are to be accepted. In order to respond to the criticisms in a systematic manner, we have summarised the claims, and what we believe are the underlying assumptions, in Table 1.

We will first address the criticism of 'textual bias'. The main focus of Genre/EAP research and pedagogy has indeed been on texts, and rightly so, we would argue. As long as higher education assessment regimes retain the written text as the main assessment mechanism, it is likely that the production of texts in unfamiliar genres constitutes the first and foremost problem for the majority of students; therefore for them the type of text they will have to produce is a good starting point for instruction. Academic Literacies researchers, as discussed earlier, have often worked with 'non-traditional' students for whom questions of identity may be particularly salient. The 'transformative approach' followed by Academic Literacies proposes the pedagogical practice of 'exploring alternative ways of meaning making in academia' and 'considering the resources that writers bring to the academy as legitimate tools for meaning making' (Lillis and Scott 2007, 9). While individual factors certainly exacerbate the difficulty of academic writing, and the issues mentioned by Lillis and Scott clearly need to be considered, they cannot be the basis for mainstream writing instruction, particularly as long as institutional requirements remain unchanged. Since the conventions, intentions and assumptions of discourse communities are manifested in academic texts, it is through these texts that students will learn to understand the social practices of the discipline. This does not mean that the context and the individual predispositions of writers should be ignored (Hyland 2004, 137).

Additionally, there is no evidence in the recent literature of EAP regarding disciplines as stable, or assuming that students, once they have cracked the conventions of one discipline, can then write across other disciplines. As Hyland stated in 2004, the assumption of academic writing and discourse communities 'as monolithic and homogeneous' has existed 'until fairly recently' (2004, x), but is now outdated.

Table 1. Genre/EAP practice as perceived by Academic Literacies.

Academic Literacies claims	Perceived Genre/EAP practice	Perceived assumptions underpinning Genre/EAP
Textual bias	Making disciplinary texts the sole focus of research and teaching Pre-identifying problem as textual; ignoring wider context/identities of writers	Stability of disciplines Homogeneity of student population Homogeneity of university culture: learning textual conventions of one discipline gives access to the whole institution Uni-directionality of teacher-student relation
Normative approach	Identifying rhetorical features in text, and presenting them to students as guidelines/norm of the discipline, or even norm of the institution Accepting established institutional rules without challenging them	

The criticism that Genre/EAP is 'normative' must refer to these approaches, as a result of their history and mission, having been primarily concerned with helping students to understand and control the conventions and discourses of their chosen discipline; the aim was not to challenge underlying power relations and their influence on students' identity. The related claim that Genre/EAP approaches assume a teaching format in which the teacher uni-directionally transmits the norms of the discipline to the students neglects interactive models such as 'genre-based literacy pedagogy'. Genre-based literacy pedagogy, which is widely used in Australian universities, assesses individual student needs and helps them through a cycle of deconstructing texts, joint reconstruction and independent construction to 'acquire knowledge and understanding of the target genre and how to apply this in producing their own individual text' (Drury 2004, 235). Also, a fairly new direction of EAP, that of Critical English for Academic Purposes, has challenged conventional EAP instruction and called for a redefinitions of teachers' and students' roles (Benesch 1999; Pennycook 1997).

Since the mid-1990s, EAP researchers have rejected a teaching approach which relies on 'authoritative texts for students to imitate or adapt' (Tribble 1996, 37). EAP is now, as Hyland (2002, 385) points out, 'based on identification of the specific language features, discourse practices and communicative skills of target groups, and on teaching practices that recognise the particular subject-matter needs and expertise of learners'. The teaching methods are student-centred rather than uni-directional, including classroom comparisons of relevant genres and student reflection on discursive practices (Swales and Feak 2002). Purely text-oriented analyses leading to the teaching of features specific to individual genres have moved to 'a much richer account of the contexts in which they occur' (Jones 2004, 257). Below are some further examples from the recent literature to show that Genre/EAP approaches do indeed consider the wider context of academic writing. They are, of their very nature, oriented to both text and context.

Johns and Swales (2002) discuss difficulties experienced by undergraduate students and writers of doctoral dissertations. The authors refer to Lea and Street's (1998) concern that students are not supported in understanding the epistemological frameworks of their discipline, and propose pedagogical solutions such as critiquing existing guidelines, making features of academic writing more explicit and raising students' awareness that knowledge is contestable.

Similarly, Critical EAP scholars, such as Benesch (2009, 2001) and Canagarajah (2002), stress the need for attention to the sociopolitical contexts of writing, the exploration of students' and teachers' social identities, and the impact of power relations. Instructional approaches in the Critical EAP tradition include the critical questioning of contextual factors such as power relations and inequalities (Morgan 2009), and awareness raising of 'competing subject positions in conflicting discourse communities' (Canagarajah 2004, 117). The exploration of, and reflection on, contextual features are also seen as fundamental by researchers who use systemic-functional linguistics (Halliday 1994) as their theoretical framework (for instance, Motta-Roth 2009). Their teaching approach tries to enable novice writers to analyse how social roles and practices are constructed in texts.

These few examples show that Genre/EAP models of academic writing have long gone beyond the 'textual bias' and normative approach, and taken into account the social and contextual issues which are also the concern of Academic Literacies. To what extent these developments have made an impact on academic writing instruction

Table 2. Comparison of Academic Literacies and Genre/EAP.

Common principles	Differences
Research focus: Paying attention to institutional, disciplinary and social contexts; identity and power relations (e.g. Lea and Street 1998; Ivanič 1998; Canagarajah 2002; Benesch 2009) Teaching practice: Raising students' awareness of epistemology, identity and power relations (e.g. Lillis 2001; Lea 2004; Johns and Swales 2002; Morgan 2009)	Research focus: 'Practice', student problem (Academic Literacies) Expert and student texts/ text corpora (Genre/EAP)

at UK universities is another question, and Academic Literacies research has been useful in starting to address this.

By this stage in the argument, it is apparent that, rather than being two separate factions, Genre/EAP and Academic Literacies share much common ground, as shown in Table 2. If this is accepted, clearly the next step is to see how Genre/EAP and Academic Literacies approaches can be brought together as complementary components in an inclusive writing pedagogy for students of all backgrounds.

Some recommendations for a 'best of both traditions' approach

This final section brings us back to the higher education situation in the UK, in which, as explained earlier, academic writing instruction is mainly provided for international students by EAP, and for 'deficit' students by extracurricular means. This provision leaves a significant part of the student population out, namely the 'traditional' home students whose problems are not that obvious. Academic Literacies has played an important role in uncovering the shortcomings in instruction; however, it has not yet filled the existing pedagogical gap.

To move on from this situation, the instructional needs of students across the higher education sector must be identified through more large-scale research, as Lillis and Scott (2007) have suggested. Systematic research is also needed to obtain a more nuanced account of the texts produced by learners and expert writers across a wider range of disciplines, and to gain a fuller understanding of successful instructional practice that already exists in UK universities and elsewhere.

Thus far, several examples of discipline-specific and embedded writing instruction have been reported that seem to have the potential for a writing pedagogy for students of all backgrounds. One is the collaboration between EAP experts and subject lecturers (for Australia, Jones 2004; for the UK, Etherington 2008; Morley 2008; in the context of Writing in the Disciplines, Mitchell and Evison 2006). Several universities have opened Writing Centres in which Writing in the Disciplines underpins a pedagogy that promotes this collaboration. Writing has also been taught as part of regular subject teaching in a case study of fully embedded writing instruction (Wingate 2010; Wingate, Andon, and Cogo 2011). In these approaches, writing is to a lesser or greater extent integrated into the subject curriculum.

Three types of collaboration between EAP instructors and subject lecturers have been identified; in the first, EAP instructors teach writing on the basis of subject-specific texts and materials that they received from the subject lecturer; in the second,

EAP instructors and subject lecturers plan writing activities together; whilst in the third they carry out team teaching (Dudley-Evans and St John 1998). In the fully embedded approach, writing is taught by the subject lecturer. These approaches, if explored and evaluated in a variety of higher education contexts, could offer pedagogical solutions that combine both EAP and Academic Literacies principles for the following reasons. First, they are inclusive, not reserved for certain types of students. Second, they are discipline and context specific; the more they are linked to the teaching of subject content, the greater is their potential to raise students' awareness of the discipline's communicative and social practices.

Even though these approaches use the text as the basis of instruction, they have the potential to be transformative in the way Lillis and Scott (2007) have outlined. This is possible because they are situation-specific, as they integrate the teaching of writing with the learning of the subject, and with the writing tasks the students have to fulfil for a specific course. The more the subject lecturer is involved in this integrated writing instruction, the better are the opportunities to elicit student perspectives, consider 'the resources that writers bring to the academy' (Lillis and Scott 2007, 9), and to explore the issues of power relations and identity. If these collaborative approaches were combined with insights emerging from academic corpus projects such as MICASE and BAWE, which analyse texts produced by learners and expert writers, they could provide a compelling and genuinely inclusive response to the needs of learners across higher education. The development of academic writing could then become a truly collaborative exploration of the discipline's social practices by teachers and students. The resulting discipline-specific writing instruction programmes, based on research findings from EAP and Academic Literacies, would also address the concern that 'a relatively homogenous culture' is assumed in academic writing instruction (Lea and Street 1998, 159). Students in multi-modular or interdisciplinary programmes would be made aware of the different social practices through writing instruction integrated in each subject/discipline they are studying, and would therefore be supported in acquiring multiple literacies.

We are aware that the previous paragraphs contain a number of 'ifs', and that we are recommending a model of discipline-specific, integrated writing instruction that is so far based on a few, as yet under-researched, initiatives. The instructional reality in UK universities is still far removed from this model. However, we believe that the approach we present here can fruitfully combine Genre/EAP and Academic Literacies principles to bring about a feasible, appropriate and inclusive mainstream writing pedagogy in UK higher education. Thus, it might be possible to get the best of both worlds.

References

- Askehave, I., and J.M. Swales. 2001. Genre identification and communicative purpose: A problem and a possible solution. *Applied Linguistics* 22, no. 2: 195–212.
- Bailey, R. 2010. The role and efficacy of generic learning and study support: What is the experience and perspective of academic staff? *Journal of Learning Development in Higher Education* 2: 1–14.
- Barton, D. 1994. *Literacy*. Oxford: Blackwell.
- Baynham, M. 2000. Academic writing in new and emergent discipline areas. In *Student writing in higher education: New contexts*, ed. M. Lea and B. Stierer, 17–31. Buckingham: Open University Press.
- Bazerman, C. 1988. *Shaping written knowledge: The genre and activity of the experimental article in science*. Madison, WI: University of Wisconsin Press.

- Benesch, S. 1999. Needs analysis and curriculum development in EAP. *TESOL Quarterly* 18, no. 4: 313–27.
- Benesch, S. 2001. *Critical English for academic purposes*. Mahwah, NJ: Lawrence Erlbaum Associates.
- Benesch, S. 2009. Theorizing and practicing English for academic purposes. *Journal of English for Academic Purposes* 8: 81–85.
- Berkenkotter, C., and T.N. Huckin. 1995. *Genre knowledge in disciplinary communication: Cognition/culture/power*. Hillsdale, NJ: Erlbaum.
- Bhatia, V.K. 1993. *Analysing genre: Language use in professional settings*. Harlow: Longman.
- Biber, D. 2006. *University language: A corpus-based study of spoken and written registers*. Amsterdam: John Benjamins.
- British Academic Written English Corpus (BAWE). <http://www2.warwick.ac.uk/fac/soc/al/research/collect/bawe/> (accessed April 23, 2010).
- Canagarajah, S. 2002. Multilingual writers and the academic community: Towards a critical relationship. *Journal of English for Academic Purposes* 1: 29–44.
- Canagarajah, S. 2004. Subversive identities, pedagogical safe houses, and critical learning. In *Critical pedagogies and language learning*, ed. B. Norton and K. Toohey, 116–37. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Charles, M. 2007. Reconciling top-down and bottom-up approaches to graduate writing: Using a corpus to teach rhetorical functions. *Journal of English for Academic Purposes* 6: 289–302.
- Christie, F. 1993. Curriculum genres: Planning for effective teaching. In *The powers of literacy: A genre approach to teaching writing*, ed. B. Cope and M. Kalantzis. London: Falmer Press.
- Cox, K., and D. Hill. 2007. *EAP now! Preliminary English for academic purposes*. Harlow: Pearson Longman.
- Drury, H. 2004. Teaching academic writing on screen: A search for best practice. In *Analysing academic writing*, ed. L. Ravelli and R.A. Ellis, 233–53. London: Continuum.
- Dudley-Evans, T., and M.J. St John. 1998. *Developments in English for specific purposes*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Duff, P. 2010. Language socialisation into academic discourse communities. *Annual Review of Applied Linguistics* 30: 169–92.
- Etherington, S. 2008. Academic writing and the disciplines. In *Teaching academic writing*, ed. P. Friedrich, 26–58. London: Continuum.
- Fairclough, N. (Ed.) 1992. *Critical language awareness*. New York: Longman.
- Hafner, C.A., and C.N. Candlin. 2007. Corpus tools as an affordance to learning in professional legal education. *Journal of English for Academic Purposes* 6: 303–18.
- Haggis, T. 2006. Pedagogies for diversity: Retaining critical challenge amidst fears of ‘dumbing down’. *Studies in Higher Education* 31, no. 5: 521–35.
- Halliday, M.A.K. 1978. *Language as social semiotic*. London: Edward Arnold.
- Halliday, M.A.K. 1994. *An introduction to functional grammar*. 2nd ed. London: Edward Arnold.
- Halliday, M.A.K. 2003. *On language and linguistics*. London: Continuum.
- Halliday, M.A.K., and R. Hasan. 1985. *Language context and text: Aspects of language in a social-semiotic perspective*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Halliday, M.A.K., A. McIntosh, and P. Stevens. 1964. *The linguistic sciences and language teaching*. London: Longman.
- Hounsell, D. 1987. Towards an anatomy of academic discourse: Meaning and context in the undergraduate essay. In *The written world: Studies in literate thought and action*, ed. R. Säljö, 161–77. Berlin: Springer-Verlag.
- Hyland, K. 2002. Specificity revisited: How far should we go now? *English for Specific Purposes* 21: 385–95.
- Hyland, K. 2004. *Disciplinary discourses. Social interactions in academic writing*. Ann Arbor, MI: The University of Michigan Press.
- Ivanič, R. 1998. *Writing and identity: The discursive construction of identity in academic writing*. Amsterdam: John Benjamins.
- Johns, A.M., and J.M. Swales. 2002. Literacy and disciplinary practices: Opening and closing perspectives. *Journal of English for Academic Purposes* 1: 13–28.

- Jones, J. 2004. Learning to write in the disciplines: The application of systemic functional linguistic theory to the teaching and research of student writing. In *Analysing academic writing*, ed. L. Ravelli and R.A. Ellis, 253–73. London: Continuum.
- Jordan, R.R. 1992. *Academic writing course*. London: Nelson.
- Krause, K.L. 2001. The university essay writing experience: A pathway for academic integration during transition. *Higher Education Research and Development* 20, no. 2: 147–68.
- Lave, J., and E. Wenger. 1991. *Situated learning: Legitimate peripheral participation*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Lea, M.R. 2004. Academic literacies: A pedagogy for course design. *Studies in Higher Education* 29, no. 6: 739–56.
- Lea, M.R., and B. Street. 1998. Student writing in higher education: An academic literacies approach. *Studies in Higher Education* 23, no. 2: 157–72.
- Lea, M.R., and B. Street. 2006. The ‘academic literacies’ model: Theory and applications. *Theory into Practice* 45, no. 4: 368–77.
- Lillis, T.M. 2001. *Student writing: Access, regulation, desire*. London: Routledge.
- Lillis, T.M. 2003. Student writing as ‘academic literacies’: Drawing on Bakhtin to move from critique to design. *Language and Education* 17, no. 3: 192–207.
- Lillis, T.M. 2006. Moving towards an ‘academic literacies’ pedagogy: Dialogues of participation. In *Teaching academic writing in UK higher education*, ed. L. Ganobcsik-Williams, 30–45. Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan.
- Lillis, T.M., and M. Scott. 2007. Defining academic literacies research: Issues of epistemology, ideology and strategy. *Journal of Applied Linguistics* 4, no. 1: 5–32.
- Martin, J.R. 1989. *Factual writing: Exploring and challenging social reality*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Martin, J.R. 1992. *English text: System and structure*. Philadelphia, PA: John Benjamins.
- Martin, J.R., and D. Rose. 2007. *Working with discourse: Meaning beyond the clause*. 2nd ed. London: Continuum.
- Michigan Corpus of Academic Spoken English (MICASE). <http://micase.elicorpora.info/> (accessed April 23, 2010).
- Mitchell, S., and A. Evison. 2006. Exploiting the potential of writing for educational change at Queen Mary, University of London. In *Teaching academic writing in UK higher education*, ed. L. Ganobcsik-Williams, 68–84. Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan.
- Monroe, J., ed. 2002. *Writing and revising the disciplines*. Ithaca, NJ: Cornell University Press.
- Monroe, J. 2003. Writing and the disciplines. *Peer Review* 6, no. 1: 4–7.
- Morgan, B. 2009. Fostering transformative practitioners for critical EAP: Possibilities and challenges. *Journal of English for Academic Purposes* 8: 86–99.
- Morley, J. 2008. Writing support in British higher education: An institutional case study. In *Teaching academic writing*, ed. P. Friedrich, 125–46. London: Continuum.
- Mottha-Roth, D. 2009. The role of context in academic text production and writing pedagogy. In *Genre in a changing world*, ed. C. Bazerman, C. Bonini, and D. Figueiredo, 317–36. Fort Collins, CO: The WAC Clearinghouse.
- Northedge, A. 2003. Enabling participation in academic discourse. *Teaching in Higher Education* 8, no. 2: 169–80.
- Paltridge, B. 1996. Genre, text type, and the language learning classroom. *ELT Journal* 50, no. 3: 237–43.
- Pennycook, A. 1997. Vulgar pragmatism, critical pragmatism, and EAP. *Pergamon* 16, no. 4: 263–69.
- Prior, P. 1998. *Writing/disciplinarity: A sociohistoric account of literate activity in the academy*. Mahwah, NJ: Lawrence Erlbaum Associates.
- Raimes, A. 1991. Out of the woods: Emerging traditions in the teaching of writing. *TESOL Quarterly* 25, no. 3: 407–30.
- Russell, D., M. Lea, J. Parker, B. Street, and T. Donahue. 2009. Exploring notions of genre in ‘academic literacies’ and ‘writing in the disciplines’: Approaches across countries and contexts. In *Genre in a changing world*, ed. C. Bazerman, C. Bonini, and D. Figueiredo, 395–423. Fort Collins, CO: The WAC Clearinghouse.
- Scalone, P., and B. Street. 2006. An academic language development programme (widening participation). In *Reconfiguring Europe: The contribution of applied linguistics*, ed. C. Leung and J. Jenkins, 123–37. London: Equinox.

- Sinclair, J.M. 1991. *Corpus, concordance and collocation*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Sinclair, J.M., and M. Coulthard. 1975. *Towards an analysis of discourse*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Somerville, E., and P. Crème. 2005. Asking Pompeii questions': A co-operative approach to writing in the disciplines. *Teaching in Higher Education* 10, no. 1: 17–28.
- Street, B. 1984. *Literacy in theory and practice*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Stubbs, M. 1996. *Text and corpus analysis*. Oxford: Blackwell.
- Swales, J.M. 1981. *Aspects of articles introductions* Aston ESP Research Reports no. 1. Birmingham: University of Aston.
- Swales, J.M. 1988. *Episodes in ESP*. Hemel Hempstead: Prentice Hall.
- Swales, J.M. 1990. *Genre analysis*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Swales, J.M. 2004. *Research genres: Exploration and applications*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Swales, J.M. 2009. Plenary presentation, British Association of Lecturers in English for Academic Purposes Conference: English for Specific Academic Purposes, April 5–7, in Reading, UK.
- Swales, J.M., and C.B. Feak. 1994. *Academic writing for graduate students*. Ann Arbor, MI: University of Michigan Press.
- Swales, J.M., and C.B. Feak. 2002. *English in today's research world: A writing guide*. Ann Arbor, MI: University of Michigan Press.
- Thesen, L., and E. van Pletzen, eds. 2006. *Academic literacy and the languages of change*. London: Continuum.
- Thurston, J., and C.N. Candlin. 1997. *Exploring academic English: A workbook for student essay writing*. Sydney: National Centre for English Language Teaching and Research.
- Tribble, C. 1996. *Writing*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Tribble, C. 2009. Writing academic English – A review of current published resources. *English Language Teaching Journal* 63: 400–417.
- Wingate, U. 2010. The impact of formative feedback on the development of academic writing. *Assessment & Evaluation in Higher Education* 35, no. 3: 519–33.
- Wingate, U., N. Andon, and A. Cogo. 2011. Embedding academic writing instruction into subject teaching: A case study. *Active Learning in Higher Education*. 12, no. 1: 69–81.